

REALMSHOLD

THE FRONTIER WAR

Field Manual

The Aldenmoor Legion vs. the Skarn Clan

ALDENMOOR LEGION

Stone. Steel. Discipline.

SKARN CLAN

Bone. Timber. Ferocity.

A free, single-file real-time strategy game — runs entirely in your browser.

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1. Introduction

Realmshold is a complete real-time strategy game that lives in a single HTML file — no installs, no accounts, no downloads beyond the file itself. If you've ever enjoyed classic RTS games, this scratches the same itch with an original setting: the stone-and-steel **Aldenmoor Legion** against the bone-and-timber **Skarn Clan**.

Gather gold and timber, build up a base, train an army, and raze your opponent's stronghold — either against an AI that manages multiple bases and escalates over three rounds, or against a friend in real multiplayer. The world is scored to a procedurally generated soundtrack, units animate their actions (workers really do swing their pickaxes), and a local high-score table keeps track of your best runs.

No installation, no account, no server dependency for singleplayer. Just open the file in a browser and play.

2. Getting Started

Open the file in any modern browser. You'll land on the title screen with four choices:

- **Singleplayer vs AI** — jump straight into a match against the computer-controlled Skarn Clan.
- **Host a Multiplayer Game** — start a match for a friend to join (see Section 9).
- **Join a Multiplayer Game** — connect to a friend who is hosting.
- **High Scores** — view your local leaderboard without starting a match.

The first time you interact with the page, a brief audio unlock happens automatically — this is a standard browser requirement so the game's music and sound effects are allowed to play.

Starting resources

Resource	Starting amount	Notes
Gold	150	Mined from gold nodes
Timber	100	Chopped from tree nodes
Population cap	6	Raised by +4 per Farm built

3. Controls

Action	Input
Select a unit or building	Left-click
Select multiple units	Left-click and drag a box
Move / attack-move	Right-click a destination or an enemy
Gather (workers only)	Right-click a gold or timber node
Scroll the map	WASD or Arrow keys
Cancel a building placement	Esc
Jump the camera	Click anywhere on the minimap
Mute / unmute audio	Speaker icon in the top HUD

Order buttons

Selecting a worker shows dedicated **Mine Gold** and **Chop Wood** buttons that send them to the nearest available node without needing to click the node directly, plus **Build Barracks** / **Build Farm** (and **Build Watchtower** from Round 3 onward). Any selection also shows a **Halt** button to stop units in place and cancel their current order.

A right-click near resources only triggers gathering if every selected unit is a worker — so moving a mixed group of soldiers and workers through a forest always works as a plain move order.

4. The Two Factions

Whichever side you play, the roster works the same way — only the names and art differ. The host of a multiplayer match always plays the Legion; the guest always plays the Clan.

Aldenmoor Legion (blue) / Skarn Clan (red)

Role	Legion unit	Clan unit	HP	Damage	Range	Cost (gold/wood)	Pop
Worker	Peasant	Grunt	40	2	Melee	50 / 0	1
Melee	Swordsman	Brute	85 / 95	9 / 10	Melee	60 / 20	1
Ranged	Archer	Slinger	50 / 45	7 / 6	Long	50 / 35	1
Elite (Round 2+)	Champion	Warlord	150 / 165	17 / 19	Melee	130 / 45	2

Workers mine gold, chop timber, and construct buildings. Melee and Ranged units form the backbone of any army. Champions and Warlords are elite troops that unlock once a match reaches Round 2 — costlier and slower to train, but noticeably tougher, and visually marked with a gold plume (Champion) or a bone crest (Warlord) so they stand out on the battlefield.

5. Buildings

Legion	Clan	Cost (gold/wood)	Build time	Effect
Keep	Lair	— (starting building)	—	Trains Peasants/Grunts. Losing every Keep/Lair you own ends the match.
Barracks	War Camp	50 / 150	16s	Trains Melee, Ranged, and (Round 2+) Elite units.
Farm	Paddock	10 / 80	10s	+4 population cap.
Watchtower	Bone Spire	60 / 70	12s	Unlocks Round 3. Automatically attacks enemy units that wander into range (140 range, 9 damage, ~0.9s between shots).

A building under construction shows scaffolding and a progress bar; it can still be destroyed while building, though it starts at reduced hit points that rise as construction completes.

6. Economy

Workers gather in trips: they walk to a node, spend a little over a second and a half working it, carry a load of 10 back to the nearest friendly Keep/Lair, deposit it, and repeat. When a node runs low, a worker automatically retargets the nearest node of the same resource type.

- **Gold nodes** are richer and slower to deplete — worth defending and worth expanding toward.
- **Timber nodes** are smaller and more numerous, usually clustered near each base.
- **Population cap** starts at 6 (from your first Keep/Lair) and rises by +4 per Farm/Paddock, and by +6 for every additional Keep/Lair gained in Round 2 and 3.
- Every unit has a population cost (1 for standard units, 2 for Champions/Warlords) — training stops once your used population meets the cap.

7. Combat & the Keep Shield

Melee units fight at close range; Archers/Slingers and Watchtowers/Bone Spires fire projectiles from a distance. Idle combat units automatically engage any enemy that strays within about 140 units of their position, so a garrisoned army will defend itself without micromanagement.

The five-minute shield

Every Keep and Lair is completely invulnerable for the first 300 seconds (5 minutes) of a match. A shimmering blue dome with a countdown timer marks the effect — attacks during this window spark harmlessly off the shield instead of dealing damage. This prevents either side from winning with an early rush before any real strategy has played out.

Enemy approach alerts

If enemy fighters get within 320 units of one of your Keeps/Lairs, a red warning banner and alarm sound fire automatically (at most once every 25 seconds), so you won't be caught completely by surprise while managing the far side of the map.

8. Rounds & Progression

Win a match and the victory screen offers to continue to the next round — a fresh match on a bigger map with higher stakes. Round 3 is currently the top of the ladder.

Round	Bases per side	New unlock
1	1 (just the main Keep/Lair)	—
2	2	Champion / Warlord elite unit
3	3, including a forward base pushed into contested central territory	Watchtower / Bone Spire

Because destroying a side requires razing *every* Keep/Lair it owns, extra bases genuinely raise the stakes — your opponent (AI or human) has a fallback to defend, and so do you. The AI manages every base it owns: it builds a War Camp near each one, trains from all of them, and can target either of your bases with an attack wave.

9. Multiplayer

The host always plays the Aldenmoor Legion; the guest always plays the Skarn Clan. There are two ways to connect, offered as tabs on the Host and Join screens.

Manual Code (WebRTC)

A direct peer-to-peer connection between two browsers — works even if the file is opened completely standalone. Setup takes one round of copy-paste: the host generates a connection code and sends it to the guest (any chat app works); the guest pastes it in and generates a reply code; the host pastes that back to finish connecting.

Party Code

A short 5-character code with no copy-pasting of long connection strings — just type the same code on both sides. This method only works while the game is running inside Claude's chat interface, since it relays through Claude's own synced storage rather than a direct connection.

The main menu shows a live “network link” status line indicating whether Party Code is available in your current setup. Manual Code always works regardless of that status.

10. High Scores

Every match, win or lose, ends with a score and a classic 3-letter initials entry. Scores are saved locally in your browser and shown on a top-10 leaderboard, viewable any time from the main menu's High Scores button.

Scoring formula

Score = (round reached × 1000) + a 1000-point bonus for winning + up to 1200 more for finishing quickly on a win, or a small survival credit (up to 500) based on how long you held out on a loss.

In practice: reaching Round 3 always outranks a fast Round 1 win, and among similar results, speed (or grit) breaks the tie. Because scores are stored in your browser's local storage, they are personal to your own computer, not shared with an opponent.

11. Strategy Tips

- **Use the shield window.** The first five minutes are safe from destruction — spend them expanding your economy rather than turtling defensively.
 - **Dedicate a few workers to timber early.** A Barracks alone costs 150 wood, more than your entire starting supply, so timber is usually the bottleneck, not gold.
 - **Watch the population cap.** A Farm/Paddock is cheap (10 gold, 80 wood) — build one before you actually hit the cap, not after.
 - **Don't ignore expansion bases in Round 2+.** Losing requires losing *every* base — an undefended expansion is a soft target for the AI or a human opponent.
 - **Elite units are a late-game investment.** At 130 gold and 2 population each, a few Champions or Warlords go a long way, but they're a poor early buy while your economy is still small.
 - **Place Watchtowers to defend chokepoints or expansions** you can't garrison with full-time units — they fire automatically and need no attention once built.
 - **Listen for the enemy-approach alert.** It fires at most once every 25 seconds, so treat every alert as genuinely new information worth checking.
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Good luck on the frontier.